

"morally good" in Analects 14:25 and in 2:3 is unclear, and they do not appear to mean the same thing.

Thus, teachers of ethics sometimes leave the meaning of "morally good" undefined. Even when they do define it, they often do not attempt to provide evidence of a causal connection between various actions and moral goodness. Unlike science and logic — which, as explained in §4.1 and §4.2, share the feature of understanding causality through evidential laws — teachers of ethics may assume the existence of deep, unverifiable connections and teach accordingly. As a result, students of ethics are left to speculate for themselves the meaning of "morally good" and the evidence — if any — for the causal connection between actions and moral goodness.

In fact, the literal meaning of the key phrase in Analects 14:25 — "In ancient times, those who studied did so for themselves; today, they study for others" — suggests a more straightforward interpretation: "In the past, scholars studied for selfish reasons, while today they study to benefit others — and this is morally good." That is, "If you wish to be morally good, study not for selfish gain, but to benefit others." To arrive at the standard interpretation mentioned earlier, one must make several assumptions: that Confucius regarded the actions of ancient scholars as morally good; that "ancient scholars" refers to Confucius himself; that "for oneself" means "to cultivate oneself"; and that "for others" means "to gain recognition from others." Such an interpretation requires multiple layers of speculation beyond the literal meaning.

In the end, ethics is the speculative study and teaching of actions that are causally connected with being morally good, whatever "morally good" may mean.

Since moral goodness may vary in degree, ethics itself may also vary in degree. There is, then, the supreme good and the corresponding supreme ethics. I have referred to the supreme good in **Observation (10)** in the **Introduction**.

4.4. Causality in Religion

Religion is, in essence, a system of speculation and prayer concerning causality and the acceptance of their outcomes

The term "religion" encompasses a vast diversity of traditions across the world. Even a single religion, identified by one name, often undergoes historical transformations and splinters into numerous sects. It is neither possible nor necessary to consider them all here. Thus, in this section, "religion" refers only to a few traditions I have personally encountered. The same limitation applies to science, logic, and ethics, though I have not previously stated it.

In Japan, religion typically refers to Shinto and Buddhism. As noted in the previous subsection, Confucianism is better understood as ethics than as religion. Christians constitute only about one percent of the population, and adherents of other religions are even fewer. However, both Buddhism and Shinto have, over time, lost their inner substance, become so commonplace as to no longer draw special attention, or been adapted to serve purposes unrelated to their original spiritual intent — and as a result, they have lost their vitality. For most people, their engagement with religion is limited to customary, incidental, or nominal

participation in events such as life-cycle ceremonies (births, coming-of-age celebrations, weddings, anniversaries, funerals, and memorial visits), sightseeing at shrines and temples, or community festivals centered around religious sites — all of which are largely detached from the original spiritual aims of religion.

Shinto is a polytheistic tradition that holds that deities dwell in all natural things — seas, mountains, trees, and so on. In contrast, the central figure of Buddhism is not a god, but the Buddha — a human being who attained enlightenment.

Buddhism places the concept of causality at its core, as seen in its doctrine of karmic retribution. According to the definition in §1.5 (**Answer to Questions 1 and 3, and Much More**), which identifies divine will with causality, Buddhism does not revere a deity as such, but rather venerates divine will itself.

A central tenet of Buddhism is the belief in past, present, and future lives. Thus, karmic teachings assert that "misfortune in this life is the result of evil deeds in a past life," or that "evil deeds in this life will bring misfortune in the next." In other words, the former posits a causal connection between "committing evil in a past life" and "suffering misfortune in the present," while the latter posits a causal connection between "committing evil in the present" and "suffering misfortune in the next life." Though such claims may seem fictional today, they were perhaps the products of earnest speculation in the past about causality.

The teaching "If you commit evil in this life, you will suffer in the next" implies its converse: "If you wish to be happy in the next life, perform good deeds in this one." Since good deeds align with morally appropriate conduct, this teaching connects to ethics. In monotheistic religions such as Judaism, Christianity, and Islam, sacred texts are often regarded as sources of ethical norms. Even when these norms are presented as divine commandments, they are in fact based on ancient speculation about causality by unknown authors. Thus, religion and ethics often intermingle, sharing the feature of teaching and learning based on speculative understandings of causality.

In contrast to science and logic — which, as explained in §4.1 and §4.2, are grounded in evidential laws — ethics and religion often accept speculation as truth without demanding evidence, provided it comes from a teacher or authority. This marks a clear boundary between science and logic on one side, and ethics and religion on the other.

Religion, of course, possesses features not found in ethics. One such feature is prayer concerning causality. In Japan, people often offer coins at shrines or temples and pray, saying, "Please let such-and-such happen." This is essentially a request for the deity to establish a causal connection between one's offering and the desired outcome. Implicit in this is the belief that the deity governs causality in some way. While the Buddha, as an enlightened human, may understand causality, he does not govern it — thus, praying to him for causal intervention is misguided. In Christianity, believers pray, "Our Father in heaven, may such-and-such come to pass," and make offerings to the church. Again, this reflects the belief that God governs causality and can link one's offerings to desired outcomes. We do not pray about causality in studying ethics, much less in studying science and logic. Religious believers, moreover, often accept unfulfilled prayers without protest. Indeed, one who cannot accept unanswered prayers is scarcely considered a true believer.

Another feature of religion — not found in science, logic, or ethics — is its tendency to embellish itself in order to encourage believers to accept outcomes of speculation and prayer concerning causality. Such embellishment includes distinctive attire and furnishings, solemn rituals, festive ceremonies, magnificent temples, elegant gardens, majestic music, sacred art and sculpture, ornate scriptures, and political patronage. These elements stir the emotions of believers, subtly guiding them toward acceptance. Indeed, the very concept of a deity can be seen as a form of embellishment. In Buddhism, for example, such a divine figure holds little central importance. Buddhism does not center on a god, but rather on causality; its central figure is the Buddha — one who attained enlightenment concerning causality.

Some such embellishment — from the perspective of an outsider — may be aesthetically or spiritually uplifting, offering clarity, serenity, or healing. But because they appeal to emotion rather than intellect, they may not be beneficial for believers themselves. Islam prohibits images and statues, recognizing their potential to foster emotional idolatry. In Japan, the effectiveness of the fumi-e (Christian image trampling test) for the crackdown on Christianity during the Edo period demonstrated that idolatry can undermine true belief. Although Confucianism is better understood as ethics, its temples and historical political patronage reveal its less desirable religious aspects.

Even science and academia have minor embellishment. In many Western universities, graduates and professors wear academic gowns resembling clerical robes during ceremonies. While this may have been traditional in the past, it is now a peculiar custom. Such practices were rare in Japanese universities when I was a student, but have become more common — perhaps to appeal to international students.

Another problematic feature of religion — again, not found in science, logic, or ethics — is its tendency to infantilize believers in order to encourage acceptance of speculative teachings. This involves fostering a mindset in which even simplistic doctrines are accepted without question. For example, one Buddhist sect once taught: "If one merely chants the name of Amida Buddha, then one will attain salvation and eternal life in the Pure Land." In Christianity, even today, believers recite creeds affirming: "If the dead and the living are judged and forgiven by Jesus Christ, then they will be granted eternal life in the Kingdom of God." These are both teachings of causality — and yet, even as a child, I could not accept such simplistic claims. In Christianity, the doctrine of the Trinity — that Jesus was born of a virgin, died, resurrected, and ascended to heaven — is itself a childlike notion, and accepting it is the first threshold to becoming a believer. Such doctrines are not merely simplistic; they are irrational, that is, inconsistent with ratiocination, as defined in §1.7 (**Intellection, Perception, and Ratiocination**). In today's world, where many people understand causality, irrationality often appears indistinguishable from childishness.

In contrast, Confucianism — and ethics more broadly — likely contains no such childish teachings. It is grounded in trust in human intellect, and, of course, so are science and logic. To interpret charitably, religious leaders who teach about eternal life in simplistic terms may not be seeking to infantilize believers, but rather may be driven by a sense of mission to alleviate fear of death by any means. Such an approach may have been acceptable in the premodern era, but in today's scientifically advanced world, it is misguided. Instead, we

should teach a view of life and death grounded in biology, as explained in §3.1 (**Baton of Life**).

Another undesirable feature of religion — again, not found in science, logic, or ethics — is its tendency toward irrationality, stemming from its reliance on speculative teachings about causality. As discussed above, certain Buddhist and Christian doctrines exemplify this. Irrationality is problematic outside the realm of fiction, and when it appears in the scriptures or teachings of powerful religions, it can imply that "faith means emotionally accepting even the irrational," which may have harmful consequences for society. Science as described in §4.1, is immune to irrationality because it seeks laws governing aspects of causality, supported by evidence. Logic, too, as explained in §4.2 is inherently opposed to irrationality, because it seeks to understand causality on the basis of logical laws. Although ethics also relies on speculation about causality, its moral orientation — as the study and teaching of morally appropriate conduct — likely protects it from irrationality. Religions that closely resemble ethics may be less prone to irrationality, and some may attract followers precisely because of this resemblance. However, some religions may exploit this resemblance to equate rejection of their teachings with immorality, thereby pressuring believers into accepting irrational doctrines through fear of being judged immoral. Such religions, if any, are degenerate religions.

Another problematic feature of religion is its ancient traditionalism — the continued adherence to scriptures and doctrines formulated in antiquity. All the religions discussed in this treatise originated in ancient times. Islam, though relatively recent, builds upon Christianity, which in turn builds upon Judaism. So-called new religions also tend to draw from ancient traditions. Religion is often seen as a direct descendant of prehistoric magic, and thus carries an inherent antiquity. The antiquity of religion is problematic because the ignorance of ancient peoples often gave rise to irrational doctrines, which, as discussed above, can lead to harmful consequences. Its traditionalism is problematic because it tends to suppress creativity and intellectual independence. While ethics may acquire traditionalism when it overlaps with religion, logic and science — needless to say — are free from such constraints.

As for science, we may state the following: We cannot accept some religious creeds of ancient origin without ignoring science of modern origin (and empirical knowledge). This may have caused a conflict between religion and science — or more precisely, between ancience and modernity, ignorance and intelligence, conventionality and creativity, emotional obedience and intellectual independence, and so on.

Another undesirable feature of religion — again, not found in science, logic, or ethics — is its political entanglement. Religious authority often legitimizes political actions, while political power, in turn, supports religion. This mutual dependence has allowed ancient religions to take root in society and persist into the present. In some modern nations, Islam still maintains a close integration with political power. In Japan, the assassination of former Prime Minister Shinzo Abe in July 2022 brought to light the ties between the Unification Church and the Liberal Democratic Party. There have been — and still are — instances where political parties use religious groups to gather votes, religious groups use political parties to recruit followers, or religious leaders use religion as a pretext to enter politics.

One of the most conspicuous problems unique to religion — and not found in science, logic, or ethics — is its propensity for violence. We rarely, if ever, hear of conflicts in science, logic, or ethics escalating into violence. In contrast, religious conflicts have often led to wars, strife, massacres, terrorism, and persecution. For example, the Christian world launched the Crusades as wars against the Islamic world. The mass murder of Jews by Nazi Germany was likely rooted, at least in part, in the long-standing antagonism between Christianity and Judaism. India and Pakistan, once united under British colonial rule, were divided upon independence due to tensions between Hinduism and Islam; this division led to violent conflicts and wars, and even today, the two nations remain in a state of nuclear-armed confrontation. In Europe, the Protestant Reformation gave rise to wars and hostilities between Catholic and Protestant regions, and even in recent times, Northern Ireland — part of the United Kingdom — has witnessed ongoing conflict and acts of terrorism. In contemporary Myanmar, a Buddhist-majority country, Muslim Rohingya have been persecuted and forced to flee as refugees to neighboring Bangladesh, a Muslim-majority nation. Similarly, the ongoing wars and conflicts between Israel and its neighboring countries are likely rooted in the enduring tensions between Judaism and Islam. At the root of such events often lies the belief that "those of other faiths are evil." This is, in fact, a claim about causality — the idea that the event of holding a different faith is causally connected with the event of being evil. Moreover, underlying the belief that "those of other faiths are evil" is likely the intermingling between religion and ethics discussed above — the assumption that those who follow a different faith violate one's own moral code, and are therefore deemed evil.

There may well be other undesirable features of religion related to causality, but I will conclude my reflections here.

To summarize the features of religion related to causality discussed above — setting aside those that are undesirable, such as its intermingling with ethics, embellishment, infantilization, irrationality, ancient traditionalism, political entanglement, and propensity for violence — we may say the following: Religious teachers instruct their followers based on speculative understandings of causality. Believers accept these teachings without demanding evidence. They also offer prayers concerning causality, and accept the outcomes of such prayers, even when their wishes are not fulfilled. Believers inquire of the divine about causality, make requests, and offer thanks for divine consideration. Religious rituals that involve seeking answers from the divine are intended to convey speculative teachings about causality. Expressions of gratitude for divine responses to such inquiries or requests are signs of acceptance of the speculative teachings and the outcomes of prayer.

In this sense, religion is characterized by speculation, prayer, and acceptance concerning causality. This is the distinctive mode by which religion seeks to understand causality.

5. Eusophy as a Harmony of Science, Logic, Ethics, and Religion

As stated in the **Introduction**, Eusophy is primarily the pursuit of human omniscience in service of the survival of humankind. This section focuses on this primary nature of Eusophy.

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5.1. The Common Origin of Science, Logic, Ethics, and Religion

Abstract: Primitive humans initiated a foundational intellectual activity, whose purpose was to understand causality in order to survive as organisms. Humankind survived as a species thanks to the activity. The activity gradually changed and ramified into some branches. Four major branches gradually changed into what we now recognize as science, logic, ethics, and religion.

According to the account given in §4 (**Causality in Science, Logic, Ethics, and Religion**), the four intellectual endeavors of the modern age — science, logic, ethics, and religion — all attempt to understand causality. How, then, did these endeavors arise in the first place? This very question led to the conception of Eusophy. Since the emergence of such endeavors likely dates back to prehistoric times, we can only approach the matter through informed speculation. The foundation for such speculation — as well as for other foundational ideas — lies in **Declaration (6)**: "Humankind is but one among many species" and evolutionary theory.

Evolutionary theory teaches that species survive by adapting to their environment. However, this may be more accurately expressed by saying that species survive by adapting to the biosphere, as defined and discussed in §2.5 (**The Biosphere for Humankind**). More precisely still, the term "biosphere" may be replaced with the "bio-noo-world" — that is, the noo-world, as defined in §1.2 (**Answer to Question 2**), constituted by the entities within the biosphere and the events on them, or relations among them. Delving further, we may restate the principle as follows: species survive by adapting to causality of the bio-noo-world. For in the bio-noo-world, it is those species that adapt to its essence that survive — and the essence of any noo-world is causality. Existing species have survived not necessarily by perceiving the existence of causality or consciously responding to it, but by adapting to it.

The survival of a species requires the survival (continuation of life) of a sufficient number of individuals. Animal individuals obtain the energy necessary for survival from food. For example, most spiders catch flying insects by spinning webs in the air. This should not be understood merely as an adaptation to the environment of open air where insects fly, but rather as an adaptation to the causal connection that, in such an environment, "spinning a web" implies "capturing flying insects." Of course, it is unlikely that spiders perceive this causal connection as such.

On the other hand, animals that perform tricks in zoos likely act with the understanding that "if I respond in such-and-such a way to a certain human signal, I will receive food." This, too, should not be seen merely as an adaptation to the zoo environment, but rather as an adaptation to the causal connection that, in such an environment, "responding in a certain way to a given signal" implies "receiving food," based on the perception of this causal connection.

As we have seen, there are indeed a number of species capable of perceiving causal connections and responding to them. However, at some point, early humans — through some means — came to perceive the existence of causality more clearly than any other species, and moreover, began the intellectual endeavor of trying to understand it. For these early humans, whose survival was often threatened, this must have been a matter of utmost urgency. The initial understanding of causality that humanity acquired through this primordial intellectual effort was neither precise, nor advanced, nor extensive. Yet even so, humans acted in response to that understanding, and through such action, they adapted to causality and thereby survived.

However, as human survival became more secure, that primordial intellectual endeavor gradually branched out — first into early forms of religion, ethics, logic, and science, depending on the different aspects of causality being understood and the differing modes of understanding them. Over time, these branches continued to evolve and further diverge, eventually giving rise to the modern forms of religion, ethics, logic, and science as described in §4. It may be surmised that this process ultimately led to conflicts between religions, tensions between religion and science, and the siloing of academic communities. The term "siloed society" refers to a social condition in which individuals or groups, like octopuses each secluded in their own pots, remain isolated and disengaged from one another.

Some readers may recall the view held by historians of science that science first emerged around the time of Galileo in the seventeenth century, and may therefore find the reference to "early forms of science" in the previous paragraph somewhat puzzling. However, such conventional accounts are likely based on a different conception of what constitutes the essence of science. In contrast, science as defined in §4.1 (**Causality in Science**), especially what was referred to as "amateur science," can be understood to have existed since prehistoric times. For example, in a society that survived by hunting in groups, people would have come to recognize, through empirical evidence, causal laws such as "If everyone cooperates, then the group can capture large prey" and "If the group can capture large prey, then the group can live comfortably for a long time." In this sense, they were already engaging in a form of science.

Moreover, early humans likely combined such causal laws to arrive at another causal law: "If everyone cooperates, then the group can live comfortably for a long time." This process may be regarded as a form of primitive logic, as it involves a kind of syllogism. Moreover, from this same causal law, the normative principle "Everyone ought to cooperate" may also have emerged, based on the idea "It is good that the group can live comfortably for a long time." This process may be regarded as a form of primitive social ethics. In this ethics, "moral good" would have meant contributing to the group's comfortable life for a long time, and "cooperating with others" would have been speculated and taught as a morally appropriate conduct. Moreover, before going out to hunt, members of the group may have consulted an elder, asking questions such as "Which direction should we go today to find large prey?" and offered prayers like "May we catch large prey today," and then acted according to the elder's predictions. This sequence of actions embodies the essence of religion — speculation, prayer, and acceptance concerning causality — and may thus be regarded as a form of primitive religious practice.

This very line of surmise — either right or wrong — led to the conception of Eusophy to be explained below.

5.2. The Eusophic System of Science, Logic, Ethics, and Religion

As stated in the **Introduction**, Eusophy is a comprehensive intellectual endeavor that aims at **(2)**: the pursuit of a way for humankind to survive as a species, grounded in **Declaration (6)**: "Humankind is but one among many species." It is the integration of science, logic, ethics, and the essence of religion, as described in §4 (**Causality in Science, Logic, Ethics, and Religion**). Their roles in Eusophy are defined as follows:

1. Science and logic, as described in **§4.1** and **§4.2**, are the primary agents in the search for a way for humankind to survive as a species.
2. As stated in **§4.4**, religion is, in essence, a system of speculation and prayer concerning causality, together with the acceptance of their outcomes. What, then, do "speculation," "prayer," and "acceptance" mean in Eusophy? The answer should already be clear. What we ought to pray for is the survival of humankind. What we ought to speculate about is the path toward the fulfillment of that prayer. And the purpose of such speculation is to discover an answer worthy of universal acceptance. This essence of religion becomes necessary precisely when science or logic falls short. There are problems — such as global heating — where waiting for certainty in both science and logic may lead to irreversible consequences. In such cases, religion must step in to compensate for the limitations of science and logic, so that together they may reach a conclusion swiftly and entrust its prompt implementation to the appropriate domains.
3. As stated in **§4.3**, ethics is the speculative study and teaching of actions that are causally connected with being morally good. What, then, is the moral good in Eusophy? The answer should already be clear. It is defined as that which contributes to the survival of humankind. This should be regarded as the supreme good, since the survival of humankind constitutes the greatest good for the greatest number — namely, the entire species, from the past to the future. Ethics in Eusophy is the corresponding supreme ethics, and its role is to bind together science, logic, and the essence of religion.

Thus, Eusophy may be likened to a fan: ethics is its pivot; science and logic are the main ribs, and religion the supporting ribs.

The above definitions of the roles of science, logic, ethics, and religion in Eusophy also indicate the norms that each Eusophist ought to follow.

The Eusophic Norm: A Eusophist must, guided by the supreme ethics that "actions contributing to the survival of humankind are morally good," make it a principle to think logically on the basis of scientific findings. Yet there are many problems for which science or logic alone is insufficient, and among them are problems for which waiting idly on the grounds that "there is no sufficient scientific or logical evidence" may lead to irreversible consequences. For such problems, it is unavoidable that a Eusophist, still guided by the supreme ethics, rely not on any particular religion but on the essence of religion — speculation, prayer, and acceptance concerning causality. That is, one must pray for the survival of

humankind, speculate about the causal connections relevant to that survival, and strive to form judgments worthy of universal acceptance. These judgments must then be integrated with science and logic to reach conclusions swiftly, and their prompt dissemination and implementation must be entrusted to the appropriate domains.

Each Eusophist forms oneself in accordance with this norm. I believe that this is, for any member of humankind, the supreme manner of self-formation. Of course, I am not saying that everyone should become a Eusophist. I myself, having grown old, can no longer become one. In both **FE** and this treatise, I merely propose Eusophy; its establishment must be entrusted to those who are willing to undertake it. Should someone arise who devotes themselves to the establishment of Eusophy — especially someone who assumes a leading role — such a person is the one I would respect, and such a person's judgments are the ones I would trust. And for anyone, such a person is worthy of respect, and such judgments are worthy of trust. If we ourselves do not become Eusophists, then we ought, together with the Eusophists, to confront the threats to the survival of humankind by trusting, disseminating, and practicing their insights.

The above **Definition 2** of the role of religion in Eusophy should also be understood as a proposal for a new religion. The **ancient traditionalism** of the religions discussed in §4.4 is not merely problematic; it is contrary to human dignity. According to Declaration (6) and **Observation (7)**, humankind is a species distinguished from other species by its intellect and its civilization — defined as the totality of human knowledge acquired through intellect. In this light, contemporary civilization represents the most essential inheritable trait of humanity. To cling to the doctrines of ancient religions, born in eras of underdeveloped civilization, is to deny this defining trait. Such denial stands in opposition to the very notion of human dignity, which demands respect for the value of our intellectual nature.

The new conception of God presented in §1.5 (**Answer to Questions 1 and 3, and Much More**) — including the new notions of omnipotence, omniscience, omnipresence, omnibenevolence, and providence — aligns with traditional conceptions in many respects, yet it also diverges from them in significant ways. **Proposition on Causality** in §1.5 suggests that the universe (the noo-world) gives rise to God. Moreover, according to §1.2 (**Answer to Question 2**), the universe was created by our intellect. Thus, God, too, is brought forth by our intellect. In other words, God does not descend upon us of His own accord, nor does He return at the end of the world; rather, God is something that our intellect brings into being. Therefore, what we must do — as beings endowed with such intellect — is not to cling to religions created by ancient peoples, but to establish a religion appropriate to our own age, propagate it, and put it into practice. We must believe that we possess the intellectual capacity to do so.

In this connection, it is essential to recall the insights presented in §3.1 (**Baton of Life**) and §3.2 (**Human Flourishing**). Traditional religions have long been regarded as the primary source of life's meaning, offering narratives that explain why we exist and what we ought to live for. Yet contemporary biology, together with Declaration (6) and Observation (7), reveals that life itself already contains a clear and universal meaning: every human being exists as a

bearer of the baton of life and knowledge — a transmitter of life and of the knowledge constituting civilization to future generations.

This scientific understanding does not diminish the role of religion; rather, it provides a new foundation for it. A religion appropriate to our age must therefore recognize that the meaning of life is not bestowed from beyond the universe, nor dictated by ancient doctrines, but arises from the very nature of life itself, described in §2 (**Life and the Biosphere**). The task of religion, in its renewed form, is to articulate this meaning, to cultivate the will to carry the baton forward, and to guide humanity in fulfilling this responsibility toward the future.

As stated also in §4.4, religion often embellishes itself. Our new religion must dispense with the traditional embellishments — priestly hierarchies, elaborate rituals, sacred vestments, monumental temples, and so on. Such embellishments once served the social needs of early communities, but they do not belong to the essence of religion as understood in §4.4. Our new religion should consist only of the essence — the prayer for humankind's survival, the speculation of actions that are causally connected with the supreme good as articulated in **Definition 3** above, and the acceptance of the speculative conclusions precisely when either science or logic falls short.

The very concept of a deity can be seen as a form of embellishment. Buddhism does not center on a god, but rather on causality; its central figure is the Buddha — a human being who attained enlightenment concerning causality. Similarly, the central figures of our new religion should be persons who have attained a certain kind of enlightenment — namely, those who understand the core of this treatise and assent to it.

5.3. A Eusophic Sense of Crisis on the Eusophic Value System

As introduced in §1.8 (**The Self, Values, Emotion, Volition, and Memory**), the VS (value system) is the causal graph equipped with the value origin percept, which is a percept of the value origin event. Also, the Self (SS, spiritual system) is the IS (intellection system) equipped with VS, and as defined in §1.7 (**Intellection, Perception, and Ratiocination**), the IS consists of the PS (perception system) and the RS (ratiocination system). The Self governs the sense of value, and thereby governs the entirety of our spiritual activity, that is, the intellection, emotion, volition, and memory. A sense of crisis arises from the sense of value.

As stated in §2.1 (**Systems with Life and Survival Instinct**), a living being is a system whose purpose is the continuation of its life — that is, the autonomous self-reproduction of its components, including itself. Accordingly, as described in §1.8, the event "my life continues" must be the fundamental value origin for any living being.

Only when such a value origin event is perceived by PS, when the values of various events are evaluated by RS, and when these values are stored and recalled by memory, can a sense of crisis arise. To cultivate such a sense, one must develop the Self.

For wild animals, the danger of death is ever-present. To lack a sense of crisis is to court immediate death. The risk of death tends to decrease with body size. An adult elephant or giraffe faces fewer threats than a mouse or a rabbit. Smaller or weaker animals can reduce their risk by forming large societies or herds. Among herbivores and small fish, many live in

groups — perhaps for this very reason. Domesticated animals, including pets, likely possess a diminished sense of crisis. Their safety is ensured by their human caretakers. To become tame is, in essence, to lose one's sense of crisis toward humans.

What about humans? Young children, whose Selves are not yet fully developed, are unaware of danger. They live in brightness, unburdened by fear. But as they grow, this changes. Even so, the human sense of crisis seems far weaker than that of wild animals. One reason may be that humans form large societies — societies that domesticate individuals, offer safety, and propose alternative value origins that are less urgent than "my life continues."

But I suspect there is a deeper cause. Adults possess a well-developed Self. They know that they will die — perhaps by the age of one hundred. Yet unless death is imminent, few live in daily fear of dying. Indeed, to live each day, one cannot afford to be paralyzed by fear. To forget death is, in a sense, necessary for life. If this is true of death, how much more so for other dangers.

In short, humans have evolved to weaken their sense of crisis. The severe cases of crisis-insensitivity to global heating cannot be explained otherwise. That is why I have come to believe the following:

We must strive to cultivate a sense of crisis, on the Eusophic value system with the obvious value origin event "my life continues, and humankind survives."

5.4. A Eusophic Intellectual Exploration for the Future

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5.4.1. Untrodden Snow

Intellectual exploration may be likened to a downhill ski run. With the right equipment, a high and well-chosen starting point, a right course, and proper techniques, one can reach astonishingly distant and diverse places with astonishing speed — and all the while, with a feeling of pleasure.

Let us set aside, for now, the question of what constitutes the right equipment. As for the high and well-chosen starting point and the right course to take, these are now clear to me: it is to begin from the perspective of seeking the path to the survival of humankind, and to follow a course that leads toward that survival.

Once I stood upon that perspective, I found myself able to see what I had not seen before, to think what I had not been able to think before, and to answer questions I had previously found unanswerable. Each of these insights, each of these questions, proved to be of profound

importance. To propose Eusophy — a form of intellectual endeavor that takes as its aim the search for the path to human survival — seemed to me not only of the utmost importance, but also entirely natural. It came to me without effort.

The question "What is the highest good?" has been asked since the time of the ancient Greek and Roman philosophers, and has continued to be pursued by Western thinkers and religious leaders ever since. I hold deep respect for the early emergence of this question and the long tradition of inquiry it has inspired. That such a question has required centuries of contemplation is a testament to its profound difficulty. And yet, I now find that I can answer it — immediately, and with confidence: That which serves the survival of humankind — this is the highest good.

And yet, I did not arrive at this realization until the year I turned seventy. What a belated awakening. I cannot help but feel astonishment.

But even more astonishing is this: that no one, it seems, has proposed an intellectual endeavor like Eusophy before. From antiquity to the present day, there have been countless thinkers of great renown — and yet, none appear to have set forth such a project. Perhaps in earlier times, when the survival of humankind was not yet under threat, it was understandable that no one conceived of such an endeavor. But it has now been decades since the threats to human survival became real. I speak, of course, of global heating.

5.4.2. Essence of Intellectual Exploration

Several more years passed, and a new realization came to me. It relates to **Interrelationship (4)**: language is an expression of the mind, yet the mind is also influenced by language. This interrelationship has both merits and dangers. One danger is that the mind can be misled by inappropriate terms — whether one's own or those of others. Intellectual explorers are those who consider matters deeply. Yet this "deeply" is often replaced with expressions such as "to their roots," which can be misleading.

In Japanese, there are many words that express this idea of "root": kon-gen (根元, 根源), kon-pon (根本), kihon (基本), kiso (基礎), and so on. The characters used in these words carry rich metaphorical meanings: 根 (ne) and 本 (moto) evoke the roots of plants; 源 (minamoto) refers to the sources of rivers; 基 (motoi) and 礎 (ishizue) signify the foundations of buildings. All three sets of metaphors — roots, sources, and foundations — suggest a beginning (元). Indeed, plants begin to grow from their roots, rivers begin to flow from their sources, and building begins with laying foundations. Thus, we Japanese — and likewise the people of China and Taiwan, who share the heritage of Chinese characters — are naturally inclined, when considering matters deeply, to follow this semantic guidance toward the beginning, to trace matters back to their origins or to the distant past.

Judging from the English equivalents of these terms — root, origin, source, basis, foundation — it seems that Western thinkers, too, are drawn by similar linguistic cues toward the beginnings of matters.

Indeed, those who study the origin of life, the phylogenetic tree of evolution, fossil hominins, or the behavior of modern apes (as close relatives of humans) are all, in one way or another,

tracing backward — whether to the earliest forms of life or to the branching points of human evolution. Likewise, those who study elementary particles are pursuing the roots of matter, and in doing so, they too trace their inquiries back to the beginning of the universe and the distant past.

But this tendency to trace matters back to their beginnings or to the distant past has both merits and dangers. Setting aside the merits for now, the danger is clear: it tends to obscure our orientation toward the future. And more critically, because there were no human beings (*Homo sapiens*) in the distant past, this backward gaze tends to obscure our orientation toward humanity itself.

Indeed, those who study elementary particles have, from the outset, lost sight of the human dimension. And those who study the origin of life, evolutionary trees, fossil hominins, or apes — even if they may have begun with a human-oriented perspective — seem to have lost it, or are in danger of losing it, either by venturing too far into the past or by becoming absorbed in peripheral matters.

The fact that no one has proposed an intellectual endeavor like Eusophy may be due, in part, to the tendency among those who consider matters deeply to be guided by the semantic pull of terms like "roots" — to trace matters back to their beginnings or to the distant past, and in doing so, to lose sight of both the human and the future. They have long neglected **Universal Question (1)** "What should anyone do?" and **Eusophic Aim (2)** "The pursuit of a way for humankind to survive" — matters that concern the future of humanity.

To be fair, mathematicians are also among those who consider matters deeply. Before I turned to mathematical psychology in **MP**, I too was, like most of them, traditionally — or rather, conventionally — focused on numbers, figures, and functions, and from the outset had lost sight of both the human and the future.

In Japan, China, and Taiwan in particular, many people have likely been misled by the term *sūgaku* (数学), a translation of "mathematics" that originated, perhaps, in the *Tetsugaku Jii* (Philosophical Lexicon, 1881), and which literally means "the study of numbers." This etymology, though historically significant, is no longer appropriate for the present age.

However, in **MP**, as well as in **MN** and **FE**, I began with a human-oriented question — "What is humanity?" — and pursued not the roots of matters, but their core. Moreover, I regard humankind as merely one among many species, as stated in **Declaration (6)**, and I possess a sufficient sense of crisis, discussed in § 5.3 concerning the survival — that is, the continued existence as a species — of humankind. All of this enabled me to maintain both a human focus and a future focus, which ultimately led me to propose Eusophy.

Therefore, I have come to believe the following:

The true essence of intellectual exploration lies in preserving a human and future orientation, pursuing matters to their core, and extracting from that core their essence.

5.4.3. Extracting Essence of the Objects

The term "extracting," as I use it here, refers to the act of discerning what is latent or implicit. It takes many forms and can be found throughout the intellectual endeavors of people across cultures and eras.

For example, from the earliest times, humankind has likely observed the plants and animals in its surroundings, gradually coming to recognize the commonality we now call "life." From this recognition, people began to group all such beings together under the concept of "living things." In doing so, they extracted the idea of life from the diversity of plants and animals, and then extracted the concept of living things from the totality of things. Life came to be seen as the essence of living beings, and the possession of life as their essential nature.

In this context, the pronoun "what," as in "what has life," functions as a marker of extraction. From the perspective of linguistic morphology — the study of the structural rules of language — such pronouns may be called nominalizers, as they turn declaratives (linguistic expressions referring to events) into nominals (linguistic expressions referring to entities). But from the perspective of linguistic semantics — the study of meaning — they may more aptly be called extractors, as they serve to extract certain entities from the totality of entities.

The foundation of modern mathematics lies in the concept of the set, as explained in §A.1. (**Noological Set Theory**). And the tool for forming sets is precisely this act of extraction. In this way, the semantics of language connects to mathematics through extractors and the concept of sets.

Grammar, too, is a discipline that extracts the structural rules of language as its essence. Its origins can be traced back to ancient Greece. However, from the perspective of **MP** and **MN**, the true essence of language lies not in its morphological rules, but in its semantic ones.

Likewise, ancient Greek philosophers recognized that reasoning — particularly in the form of syllogisms — played a central role in thought, and thus laid the foundations of logic. They extracted these logical laws as the essence of thinking itself. Ancient Greek grammar and logic eventually developed into modern mathematical logic, which now serves as an indispensable tool in AI engineering, in the semantics of language, and — more importantly — in answering the questions posed in MP, MN, and **FE**: "What is the universe?" "What is intellect?" "What is God?"

In the seventeenth century, Newton explained the motion of the planets around the sun by means of the law of universal gravitation, using mathematics. In doing so, he extracted this law as the essence of planetary motion. In the eighteenth century, Linnaeus began the classification of living organisms, not by tracing each species back to its origin, but by extracting essence and essential nature — other than simply "life" or "being alive" — from plants and animals, and using these to classify them. In the nineteenth century, Darwin published "On the Origin of Species," but he did not trace each species back to its root. Rather, he pursued the phenomenon of the rise and fall of species to its core, and from there extracted the law of evolution as its essence.

Indeed, not only Darwin, but all the figures mentioned above — whether explicitly or implicitly — pursued matters not to their origins or roots, but to their core, and from that core extracted their essence or essential nature.

The laws they extracted — such as the law of universal gravitation or the law of evolution — could not have been discovered through direct observation alone, even with the aid of telescopes, microscopes, or X-rays. Newton reasoned that just as an apple falls to the ground due to gravity, so too do the planets fall continuously toward the sun under gravity, and in doing so, orbit it. Darwin's reasoning is well known and widely taught in schools.

Thus, extraction includes not only observation with the physical eye, but also what we might call observation with the mind's eye — that is, reasoning. The examples of Newton and Darwin represent paradigmatic cases of such extraction.

There is a reason why mathematics appears so frequently in these explanations. Mathematics, in its original and proper sense, is not merely the study of numbers, shapes, or functions. Rather, it is a tool of mathematical science as discussed in §A.3 (**Mathematical Science and Models**) — a means of understanding phenomena by extracting mathematical concepts that express the core essence or essential nature of things, through observation and reasoning, and then analyzing them mathematically. Here, "mathematical" no longer means "pertaining to numbers, shapes, or functions," but rather "logical on the foundation of set-theoretic concepts."

Earlier in this section, I wrote: "Let us set aside, for now, the question of what constitutes the right equipment." Mathematics in the above sense, alongside empirical observation and experimentation in science, is surely one of the right pieces of equipment. Without acquiring and using mathematics, our intellectual endeavors risk being constrained — our hands and feet bound, our paths narrowed, misdirected, or needlessly prolonged. This is symbolized by the fact that even questions such as "What is the universe?" "What is intellect?" "What is God?" can be answered with precision through mathematical science, as suggested in §1 (**The Universe, Intellect, and God**).

Philosophers, theologians, and scholars of religion ought to be those who can answer such questions with clarity. And yet, perhaps because they have distanced themselves from mathematics, they have largely failed to do so. Indeed, philosophers have long debated the existence of God — between theism, atheism, and agnosticism. While the seriousness of the question is undeniable, the fact that this debate has continued for over a thousand years suggests that it has been, in many ways, unproductive. Gödel, whose work I discussed in §1.9 (**Original Sin, Intellectual Incompleteness and Completeness**), even attempted a logical proof of the existence of God. But this, too, has become the subject of further philosophical controversy.

To be fair, mathematicians — myself included, before I turned to mathematical psychology in MP — have largely remained bound by convention, focusing narrowly on numbers, shapes, and functions, and perhaps losing sight of the fact that mathematics was originally meant to serve as a tool for mathematical science.

There are many such unproductive paths. To avoid them — and to find our way out of them — I invite you to read on, and to learn about Eusophy.

5.4.4. An Alarm of Climate Scientists

Earlier, I wrote: "this tendency to trace things back to their beginnings or to the distant past has both merits and dangers. Setting aside the merits for now..." But in truth, the merits and significance of tracing things back to their origins or to the distant past must also be evaluated in terms of whether they serve a human-oriented and future-oriented perspective — that is, whether they contribute to the betterment of humanity's future.

A striking example of such merit and significance is the alarm that climate scientists have been sounding — what I referred to earlier as **Heating Alarm (3)**. This alarm can be elaborated as follows:

Elaborated Heating Alarm: Since the Industrial Revolution, which began in Britain in the latter half of the 18th century, humans have been burning fossil resources on a massive scale, releasing vast amounts of CO₂ (carbon dioxide) into the atmosphere. As a result, the atmospheric levels of CO₂ has risen to dangerous levels, leading to global heating. Historically, CO₂ has been both emitted into and sequestered by the Earth's crust, oceans, and living organisms. Despite fluctuations, its atmospheric levels remained relatively stable over long periods. However, since the Industrial Revolution, the rate of human-induced CO₂ emissions has far outpaced the Earth's natural capacity to reabsorb it, resulting in a net accumulation and consequent global heating. This rise constitutes a grave and immediate form of primary biospherical damage, and poses a serious threat to the survival of humankind in the near future. Therefore, global heating must be halted by ending the large-scale combustion of fossil resources and achieving net-zero CO₂ emissions. And at present, it is still possible to do so.

This alarm warrants further explanation.

First, the term "fossil resources" refers to underground materials derived from ancient life forms, such as coal, petroleum, and natural gas. These resources not only emit gases that cause global heating and atmospheric pollution when used as fuel, but also serve as raw materials for synthetic resins (plastics) and chemical fibers. When incinerated, these materials release gases; when discarded, worn down, or degraded, they release microplastics into the environment. These processes contribute to global heating and to the pollution of the atmosphere, soil, rivers, lakes, and oceans — forms of biospherical damage.

This is why, in this treatise, I often refer to coal, petroleum, and natural gas not as fossil fuels but as fossil resources. Terms such as "carbon offsetting," "carbon neutrality," and "decarbonization" are also commonly used to describe efforts to reduce emissions. However, I find the focus on "carbon" in such terms to be misleading. Carbon is not the problem. Unlike carbon dioxide (CO₂), carbon itself is an essential element — indispensable to all living organisms, including humans, as a fundamental component of organic matter. It is carbon dioxide, not carbon, that must be identified as the true culprit.

My insistence on precise terminology as above stems from **Interrelationship (4)**: language is an expression of the mind, yet the mind is also influenced by language. This interrelationship has both merits and dangers. One danger is that the mind can be misled by inappropriate terms — whether one's own or those of others.

It is also necessary to explain why global heating constitutes a grave and immediate form of primary biospherical damage. Terms such as "climate change," "climate crisis," "climate emergency," "climate catastrophe," "climate dystopia," and "climate apocalypse" are often used in this context. While words like "crisis," "emergency," and "catastrophe" may be appropriate, I believe we should avoid using terms like "climate" and "change."

The term "change" carries the connotation of something that shifts on its own, which may lead people to believe that global heating is a natural phenomenon, unrelated to human activity. This undermines the acceptance of the scientific findings presented by climate researchers.

Likewise, the term "climate" tends to direct attention toward atmospheric and terrestrial phenomena — such as temperature, wind, and precipitation — while drawing attention away from the oceans. It also obscures the true nature of the problem, which cannot be neatly categorized under the label of "climate."

The real problem: Global heating ultimately leads to the depletion of surface resources — such as freshwater, arable land, fisheries, forests, and habitable land — and to increased health risks, thereby making our daily lives increasingly difficult.

The first issue with focusing solely on "climate" is that the oceans have absorbed a significant portion of the excess heat and CO₂ from the atmosphere. Thus, global heating has likely affected the oceans — through rising temperatures, acidification, and shifts in marine ecosystems — even before its full effects are felt in the atmosphere or on land. Once the oceans reach their limits of absorption, the heat and CO₂ they have stored will be released back into the atmosphere.

The second issue is that abnormal heatwaves in the atmosphere and oceans have already led to the rapid melting of glaciers, icebergs, and ice sheets in mountainous and polar regions. These are direct consequences of global heating. In addition, abnormal cold spells, droughts, torrential rains, and violent storms have become more frequent worldwide. These phenomena can be understood by analogy: just as heating a flask of water causes irregular changes in the temperature, density, and flow of the water and air inside, so too does global heating increase the turbulence and unpredictability of the Earth's atmospheric and oceanic systems.

As a result, surface resources are being depleted in real and measurable ways: water shortages for daily life and industry, declining agricultural and livestock productivity, collapsing fisheries, forest fires caused by dry air, landslides and floods from heavy rains, and the submergence of inhabited areas due to rising sea levels. According to the World Health Organization, heatstroke and other health hazards — both direct and indirect consequences of global heating — are also on the rise. All of these factors are making daily life more difficult for people around the world.

In this way, global heating and the biospherical changes it causes — both directly and indirectly — constitute a grave and immediate form of biospherical damage. Moreover,

because global heating is the primary cause of many other forms of biospherical damage, it can be called a primary biospherical damage.

5.4.5. The Venusian Scenario

Global heating poses a serious threat to the survival of humankind in the near future. This is because of the following projection:

Projection: If we continue to burn fossil resources and release large quantities of CO₂ into the atmosphere, the atmospheric levels of CO₂ will continue to rise. As a result, the greenhouse effect will intensify, and global heating will accelerate. Eventually, the natural world will begin to release even greater quantities of greenhouse gases that it has long stored — gases such as water vapor, CO₂, and methane, which are currently sequestered in the oceans, seabed hydrates, permafrost, and forests. This natural release, combined with ongoing heating, will create a vicious cycle in which heating begets further emissions, and those emissions, in turn, drive further heating. As this cycle repeats, the cumulative effect will be an accelerating rise in global temperature, ultimately rendering the Earth too hot for human habitation.

The term "accelerating rise" here refers to a runaway increase — an escalation beyond human control. Such runaway phenomena are not limited to global temperature. They can be either accelerating or non-accelerating, but in this case, the concern is specifically with accelerated runaway heating.

A vivid example of such escalation occurred in 2020, when the global spread of COVID-19 led to a sudden and dramatic spike in infection rates. Graphs depicting the number of infections showed a steep, upward curve — a textbook case of an accelerating runaway phenomenon.

The phrase "too hot for human habitation" brings to mind the planet Venus. Venus, often called Earth's "sister planet," has an atmosphere composed almost entirely of CO₂ and an extremely high surface pressure. As a result, its surface temperature reaches approximately 470°C, making it utterly uninhabitable for humans. While there may be other such planets, Venus is particularly evocative: it resembles a vision of Earth after a catastrophic escalation of global heating, a world where the biosphere has vanished in a blaze of heat.

For this reason, I refer to the above projection as the Venusian Scenario. It is one of the Apocalypse Scenarios, but it is an avoidable apocalypse — and therefore worth serious consideration.

In this scenario, the phrase "greenhouse gases that it (the natural world) has long stored" refers to substances such as water vapor, CO₂, and methane, which are currently sequestered in the oceans, seabed hydrates, permafrost in the far north, and forests. The phrase "natural release" refers to the breakdown of these storage mechanisms due to rising ocean and air temperatures — increased evaporation, thawing of hydrates and permafrost,

and more frequent forest fires due to drier air. There may be other mechanisms of natural storage and release, some of which remain unknown.

Among greenhouse gases, methane is particularly concerning. Although it receives less attention than water vapor or CO₂, methane is stored in many of the same places. While its atmospheric lifetime is relatively short — on the order of a decade — its greenhouse effect is dozens of times stronger than that of CO₂.

Thus, we must be concerned not only with CO₂ but also with the atmospheric levels of methane. According to a graph published by the Japan Meteorological Agency in November 2023, titled "Trends in Atmospheric Methane Levels," the global average levels of methane, after a brief plateau in the early 2000s, has been rising acceleratingly since around 2007.

The Venusian Scenario, when broken down through repeated syllogistic reasoning, reveals the underlying causal structure:

1. If we continue to burn fossil resources and release large amounts of CO₂, then the atmospheric levels of CO₂ will continue to rise. If the atmospheric levels of CO₂ continues to rise, the greenhouse effect will intensify, and global temperature will continue to rise. If global temperature continues to rise, the natural world will eventually release even greater quantities of stored greenhouse gases. If such gases are released in greater quantities, global temperature will rise further. And if global temperature rises further, such gases will be released in greater quantities. (This underlined portion repeats.)
2. If this underlined portion repeats, the effect of "global temperature rises further" will accumulate. If this effect accumulates, global heating will accelerate. And if global heating accelerates, the Earth will, before long, become Venus-like — a planet too hot for human life.

At present, many countries around the world have set a goal of achieving net-zero CO₂ emissions by 2050. This is likely because these projections indicate that, without such action, global temperature will continue to rise uncontrollably.

Some critics argue that these projections are unreliable. However, current statistics show that the vast majority of climate scientists consider them to be valid. Even if we were to concede, for the sake of argument, that the probability of these projections being accurate is only 50%, we must weigh the consequences of two possibilities:

- The harm of not acting on a valid projection, versus
- The harm of acting on an invalid one.

In earlier times, when the Venusian Scenario had not yet been proposed, the balance between these two might have been debatable. But now, the situation is different. If the projection is valid and we fail to act, the worst-case outcome is the Venusian transformation of Earth — an irreversible catastrophe. If the projection is invalid and we act regardless, the worst-case outcome is economic loss from halting the large-scale combustion of fossil resources — a loss that is, in principle, reversible. Clearly, the former risk is far more severe.

Now, the surface temperature of Venus is approximately 470°C. This extreme heat is likely capped by certain physical laws. In the case of infectious diseases, such as COVID-19, even if the number of infections rises rapidly, the eventual increase in immunity leads to a peak and subsequent decline. Similarly, during the 2011 Great East Japan Earthquake, the temperatures of the reactor cores at the Fukushima No.1 Nuclear Power Plant rose sharply, but eventually peaked and declined due to cooling efforts. An article titled "Will Global Warming Run Out of Control?" published by Japan's National Institute for Environmental Studies suggests the following:

While the mechanisms of natural greenhouse gas release — especially methane — are not yet fully understood, current research does not conclusively indicate that global temperature will continue to rise without limit.

From this, we may cautiously hope that even if global temperature rises rapidly for a time, it may eventually peak or decline for some reason. Indeed, we must hope so — for without such hope, there is no solace.

And yet, hope alone is not enough. What matters is where the temperature peaks or begins to decline. Even if it levels off at 470°C, like Venus, that would offer no salvation.

History offers grim reminders. During the Black Death in the mid-14th century, the number of infections soared uncontrollably. Before the peak was reached, countless lives were lost. According to a National Geographic Japan article dated May 4, 2020, titled "The Black Death That Killed One-Third of Europe: A Historical Lesson," one-third of Europe's population perished. Such a peak offers no comfort.

The article quotes a historian who suggests that the plague helped usher in the Renaissance and modern European society. While this may reflect the historian's diachronic and holistic view of society, it seems to overlook the dignity of each individual life lost in the process.

Moreover, if we take an even broader historical view, we see that the Industrial Revolution — originating in modern European society — led to the large-scale combustion of fossil resources and massive CO₂ emissions. This, in turn, has caused global heating, which now threatens the very survival of humankind.

In the case of the Fukushima No.1 Nuclear Power Plant, the reactor cores likely stopped heating only because they had already melted down — a catastrophic outcome. Thus, even that peak was a mixed result, not a true salvation.

As for global temperature, even a few degrees of rise beyond pre-industrial levels is enough to make human life difficult. In August 2024, for example, Japan experienced daily highs near 40°C across many regions. News reports warned of "life-threatening heat," advised people to avoid non-essential outings, and predicted negative impacts on agriculture, as well as increased damage from typhoons and prolonged heavy rains.

Given that Japan's summer temperatures have already risen several degrees above pre-industrial levels, a few more degrees of heating — even if followed by a plateau — would offer no salvation. There is no time left to waste.

Some reports have described the current heat as a "disaster-level heatwave." But this is not a natural disaster. It is a man-made calamity, a form of pollution caused by the massive combustion of fossil resources and the resulting CO₂ emissions. And because this human activity can be halted by transforming society, the disaster can still be prevented.

Yet those at the helm of society do not appear to be taking the need for transformation seriously. One cannot help but ask, in all sincerity: "What exactly do they intend to do?"

Only when we see the leaders of society take this crisis seriously — only when they show us, clearly and unequivocally, that they are committed to change — will we, the people, feel reassured and inspired to walk alongside them toward a better future. Like the people led by the goddess of liberty in Delacroix's painting of the French Revolution. What, then, is the goddess of social transformation? Tokyo Electric Power Company (TEPCO) has published a roadmap for the decommissioning of the plant, with completion targeted around 2051. Although the meltdown of three reactor cores was a grave disaster, the mere publication of this roadmap has brought a measure of reassurance.

We now await similar roadmaps from governments and from industries involved in power generation, manufacturing, and transportation — roadmaps toward the goal of net-zero CO₂ emissions by 2050. The United Kingdom and the state of California in the United States, for example, have announced bans on the sale of gasoline-powered and CO₂-emitting vehicles by 2035. These announcements can be seen as parts of such roadmaps.

While we may hope that the "goddess of social transformation" will soon descend, the logic of the Venusian Scenario compels us to extend it as follows:

If we continue on our current path, global temperature will rise uncontrollably, and before it ever peaks or declines, the Earth will become too hot for human life.

As discussed above, it is a mistake to consider global temperature, infectious disease case counts, nuclear reactor core temperatures, and CO₂ emissions in isolation. These phenomena are not separate events, but rather interconnected outcomes of a continuous chain of human actions.

In the mid-14th century, the Black Death swept across Europe. This pandemic, in turn, contributed to the emergence of the Renaissance and the birth of modern European society. That society gave rise to the Industrial Revolution, which led to the large-scale combustion of fossil resources and the massive release of CO₂. This, in turn, caused global heating and the rapid advancement of science and technology. As a result, nuclear fission came to be used for weapons and power generation, leading to fears of nuclear war and the occurrence of catastrophic nuclear accidents.

While pandemics may appear to be natural disasters, they too are, in fact, rooted in human social behavior. Thus, all of these events — pandemics, global heating, nuclear risks — are not isolated incidents, but rather a single, continuous sequence of human-caused phenomena that now threaten the survival of our species.

Therefore, we must go beyond analyzing each issue in isolation. We must quantify not only infection rates, reactor core temperatures, CO₂ emissions, and global temperature, but also the risks associated with the use of nuclear technology. Ultimately, we must develop a way to quantify the aggregate risk of human extinction — a measure of the threats to human survival that arise from our own actions.

The Doomsday Clock, maintained by the Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists, may be seen as the first attempt at such quantification. However, it remains largely a subjective measure.

Humanity has not yet developed an objective method for quantifying the threats to its own survival — threats that are, in essence, self-inflicted. And if we consider the continuous chain of events described above, it seems clear that this unknown self-extinction risk is steadily increasing.

This concludes the explanation of the climate scientists' alarm. What this alarm calls for is reflection on the past, recognition of the present, a sense of crisis about the future, and action grounded in all three. Specifically, it urges us to reflect on the past — that global heating has been caused by humanity's large-scale combustion of fossil resources and the resulting massive CO₂ emissions; to recognize the present — that global heating constitutes a grave, immediate, and primary form of biospherical damage; to feel a sense of crisis about the future — that this heating threatens the survival of humankind in the near term; and to act — to halt the combustion of fossil resources and achieve net-zero CO₂ emissions.

This alarm traces the origins of global heating back to the time of the Industrial Revolution, using the methods of mathematical science to analyze the past. It also uses those same methods to forecast the near future, and based on those forecasts, it proposes concrete actions to be taken in the present. In doing so, it implicitly issues the following warning:

If we spend all our time looking backward, we may lose the future before we even understand the past.

In this form of climate science, I see a model — an ideal embodiment — of what Intellectual Exploration for the Future ought to be.

5.5. A Eusophic Endeavor for Peace and Security

As stated in the **Introduction**, activities for Peace and Security take many forms. Yet among them is one activity not mentioned there, but which is arguably the most important. This is the endeavor to abolish nuclear weapons.

The danger of nuclear weapons needs no explanation. There is an American film that portrays this danger with remarkable clarity: *Planet of the Apes*, released in 1968 at the height of the Cold War between the United States and the Soviet Union and starring Charlton Heston. The story begins with a manned space probe returning home, only to crash-land on a planet resembling Earth. There, beings who look like apes but possess a human-like civilization rule over beings who look like humans but live like wild animals. These "humans" are hunted, kept, or stuffed as specimens. The protagonist, a member of the space crew, is treated as one of these human-like creatures, captured, and — angered by this — resists and

escapes. The film ends with a shocking and despairing conclusion, one that seems to foretell the future of the Cold War. The planet is revealed to be Earth itself. According to the protagonist's explanation, the six months spent aboard the near-light-speed spacecraft corresponded to seven hundred years on Earth. During that time, humanity had lost its civilization — presumably due to nuclear war — and apes, inheriting part of that lost civilization, had become the new rulers of the planet.

The film contains not only warnings about nuclear weapons but also various forms of satire and criticism directed at human society, some of which relate to the present treatise. For example, the entire storyline — reversing the positions of humans and apes — may be read as a satire of the passage in Genesis that states that God created humans to rule over the animals. Likewise, the image of the deity worshipped by the apes, which takes the form of an ape and appears comical, is surely a satire of the Genesis passage that says God created humans in His own image, as well as a critique of the excessive anthropomorphizing of the divine. Beyond this, the many human-like behaviors exhibited by the apes in the film each feel like a satire or criticism of human conduct. In fact, even this treatise of mine is not free from such satire. In the Introduction, I presented **Universal Question (1)** "What should anyone do?" Yet if an ape were to ask, "What should any ape do?" it would be undeniably comical. And if someone were to ask me why it is not equally comical for a human to ask the same question, I would find myself at a loss for an answer. With such reflections in mind, I strongly encourage you to watch the entire film in some medium. Although sequels exist, I do not recommend them, as their themes differ from that of the original.

Let us now survey the history and present state of nuclear armament in the world. During the Second World War, the United States, fearing that Germany might develop nuclear weapons, created the atomic bomb in order to outpace it. The Soviet Union (Russia), China, and North Korea — nations regarded with hostility by the United States because of their economic ideologies — acquired nuclear weapons. France and the United Kingdom, fearing Russia, acquired them as well. India, fearing its neighbor China, obtained nuclear weapons, and Pakistan, which regards India with hostility and fear due to religious differences, followed suit. China, having become an economic great power and thereby increasingly regarded as a primary adversary by the United States, began expanding its nuclear forces. Iran, which turned hostile toward the United States after the Islamic Revolution, has sought nuclear armament, while Israel — backed by the United States and regarded with hostility by Iran and other surrounding Islamic states — has acquired nuclear weapons. Russia, having invaded Ukraine, has hinted at the use of nuclear weapons, threatening both Ukraine and the NATO countries supporting it. This chain reaction of nuclear proliferation — born of hostility and fear and spreading ever since — must be halted and reversed.

The catastrophic scale of destruction that would result from the use of nuclear weapons needs no elaboration. Yet there is another grave aspect — the ideology underlying nuclear weapons — which seems far less widely recognized. The belief that the devout will be granted eternal life is common in many traditional religions. In other words, it presupposes that God possesses the authority and power over life and death. And this, in turn, can lead to the inverse idea: that one who possesses the power over life and death becomes godlike. It is not difficult to suspect that such an idea lay behind the world's first nuclear test conducted by the United States. The test was named the Trinity Test, a name that unmistakably evokes the

Christian Holy Trinity. According to what was written in §5.2 (**The Eusophic System of Science, Logic, Ethics, and Religion**), under the supreme ethics that regards the survival of humankind as the supreme good, we must first think logically on the basis of scientific knowledge, and only when science and logic are insufficient should we seek assistance from the essence of religion — speculation and prayer concerning causality and the acceptance of their outcomes. When a problem lies fully within the power of science and logic, religion must not be given a role. According to the biological knowledge explained in §2 (**Life and the Biosphere**), it is not God who grants us life, but the principle of life itself. And according to the view of life and death derived from that principle and explained in §3.1 (**Baton of Life**), it is not the devout who are granted eternal life; rather, every person is a participant in the relay that allows life to continue eternally, entrusted with the mission of receiving and passing on the Baton of Life. From such a view of life and death, the dangerous notion of possessing the power over life and death cannot possibly arise.

It is widely known that one of the considerations that led the United States to decide to use atomic bombs on Japan was the maxim "Of two evils choose the lesser." In other words, it was believed that if one weighed the total number of casualties that would result from a prolonged war without the use of atomic bombs against the total number of casualties if the war were ended quickly through their use, the latter would be the lesser and therefore justifiable. This maxim may be useful and harmless in everyday life. However, when applied to war or conflict, it can lead to grave consequences. A nuclear strike can be regarded as a form of carpet bombing — an attack that blankets an entire urban area as though covering it with a carpet, indiscriminately killing large numbers of non-combatants. Carpet bombing itself appears to have been proposed in response to the prolongation of the First World War. In other words, the same reasoning that justified the use of atomic bombs had earlier justified carpet bombing. Since then, carpet bombing has been carried out repeatedly: Germany bombed Guernica during the Spanish Civil War, as made famous by Picasso's painting; Japan carpet-bombed China; and the United States and the United Kingdom carpet-bombed Germany. The culmination of this logic was the atomic bombings of Hiroshima and Nagasaki by the United States. Nor did it end there. During the Vietnam War, the United States did not use nuclear weapons, but it did carpet-bomb North Vietnam with napalm. And behind modern terrorism, too, one can often discern the same pattern of reasoning, with "atomic bomb" and "war" replaced by "terror" and "conflict."

The victims of carpet bombing and terrorism are non-combatants. All killing and injuring of non-combatants must be reflected upon and eliminated, regardless of whether it occurs in wartime or not, regardless of who the actors are, what means are used, or how great or small the scale of harm may be. Concerning Japan's surrender in 1945, there is a view that it was not the atomic bombings of Hiroshima and Nagasaki that compelled surrender, but rather the Soviet Union's entry into the war, which extinguished Japan's hope for Soviet mediation and made it necessary to avoid Soviet occupation. Given the Soviet Union's appetite for territorial and ideological expansion, the fact that half of Germany — having surrendered earlier than Japan — was occupied by the Soviets, and the Japanese government's prioritization of preserving the national polity (the imperial system) over the safety of its people, this view is plausible. If so, the idea that "a war or conflict can be ended quickly by inflicting massive harm on non-combatants" is likely mistaken. A more accurate view may be that "military forces and other combatant groups, whose very *raison d'être* lies in fighting, will continue

fighting regardless of how many non-combatants are killed or injured." It is inconceivable that a nation would possess only low-yield nuclear weapons and use them solely against combatants. High-yield nuclear weapons can be used only for the indiscriminate mass killing of non-combatants. Therefore, to refuse to support the abolition of nuclear weapons is effectively to refuse to oppose the indiscriminate mass killing of non-combatants — something that is truly shameful.

There remains a slight possibility that nuclear explosives could serve the survival of humankind: they might be used to prevent the collision of a small celestial body with Earth. In September 2022, the United States began an experiment in which a spacecraft was deliberately crashed into a small asteroid in the solar system in order to alter its orbit. Such methods are effective for deflecting distant asteroids whose potential collision with Earth lies far in the future. However, small celestial bodies that are not recognized as planets can, at present, go unnoticed until they have already approached or passed near Earth. As a last resort for preventing the impact of such a belatedly discovered object, one might consider using nuclear explosives to destroy it or alter its trajectory. For this purpose, it would be necessary to maintain nuclear devices under the control of the United Nations, and this in turn requires the elevation of the United Nations described in **Observation (8)** in the Introduction.

6. What Should Anyone Do? — Ultimate Eusophic Enlightenment and Fulfillment

In light of the discussions from the **Introduction** through §5 (**Eusophy as a Harmony of Science, Logic, Ethics, and Religion**), I hold that what a person ought to do is to contribute — guided by supreme ethics — to the survival of humankind and its civilization. Moreover, Eusophy, the new intellectual endeavor grounded in supreme ethics and devoted to exploring the path toward the survival of humankind and its civilization, is an urgent discipline both for humanity as a whole and for each individual. Its swift establishment, propagation, and practice are earnestly desired.

Therefore, if you are a scholar endowed with intellectual excellence, I ask that you participate in the establishment of Eusophy. If you are a student with academic ability, I ask that you pursue fields of study that lead toward Eusophy. If you possess leadership or the capacity for action, I ask that you engage in activities that propagate Eusophy or put it into practice. If you have political, economic, or social influence, I ask that you support such scholarship and such activities.

And most importantly, even without any special abilities, and without forcing yourself into heroic contributions, you can directly contribute to the survival of humankind and its civilization simply by pursuing human flourishing described in **§3.2** — that distinctively human form of happiness — and by living in ways that help present and future people pursue the same.

If circumstances — such as illness or disability — make such a pursuit impossible, then that cannot be helped. But if not, then I ask that you pursue this form of happiness, and through your profession or service, help present and future people to live such lives. For it is precisely through many people living in this way — passing on knowledge and linking generation to

generation without interruption — that the survival of humankind and its civilization is sustained.

I lifted up mine eyes unto the hills, from whence truth hath come.

— Be fruitful, and multiply, and flourish upon Eusophic values.

7. Humanosphere Revolves around Religion

In the Introduction, I introduced the concept of the humanosphere in contrast with the biosphere, and wrote that "the dynamism and network of the humanosphere appear to be even more complex than those of the biosphere, and much about them likewise remains unclear." Yet through the process of writing this treatise, one conviction has taken shape in my mind regarding the dynamism and network of the humanosphere: namely, that the humanosphere revolves around Religion. Here, however, "Religion" refers not only to existing religions but also to the essence described at the beginning of §4.4 — that is, speculation and prayer concerning causality and the acceptance of their outcomes. And this conviction is, in fact, a natural consequence of **Observation (7)** in the Introduction: "Humankind is distinguished from other species by its intellect and its civilization." As I wrote immediately after Observation (7), civilization is defined as the totality of human knowledge acquired through intellect. Yet the details of that knowledge, and the processes by which it was obtained, are beyond the reach of most people — impossible to know and impossible to understand. Thus, for most people, such knowledge can only be believed or disbelieved — in other words, accepted as true or refused to accept; it belongs to the domain of the essence of religion described above. The most typical example of such knowledge is academic knowledge, especially scientific knowledge. The details of scientific knowledge are beyond the understanding of most people. Therefore, for most people, the results of science are objects of belief or disbelief, and thus belong to the domain of religion. As stated at the beginning of §4.1, science is the totality of endeavors to discover, with evidence, the laws that govern aspects of causality. And in that section, I explained that science is clearly distinguished from the essence of religion precisely because of "with evidence." Yet that evidence has meaning only for scientists themselves. For most people, because they cannot understand its details, that evidence is not evidence at all.

Among those who object to **Heating Alarm (3)** presented in the Introduction, some claim that "climate scientists introduce arbitrary assumptions in order to obtain the conclusions they desire." This is a misunderstanding. Climate scientists are, in fact, unable to introduce certain assumptions that are necessary. The reason is that the human characteristics listed in Observations (9) through (14) in the Introduction further accelerate global heating and obstruct effective action against it. Therefore, any attempt to predict the future of global heating must include these Observations as part of its assumptions. However, the content of these Observations concerns the human mind, and climate scientists lack the ability to incorporate such factors. Indeed, no scientist can do so. Since they do not take into account the very factors that further accelerate global heating and obstruct effective action against it, the Heating Alarm is necessarily an optimistic prediction. If all such factors were properly incorporated, the resulting prediction would surely be more severe than the Heating Alarm. Yet even obtaining a more accurate prediction by considering everything that ought to be considered has little meaning. As stated in the previous paragraph, scientific predictions are,

for anyone other than scientists, merely objects of belief or disbelief. For those who refuse to believe them, no prediction — however accurate — has any effect.

A clear example of this meaninglessness can be seen in the case of ozone-layer depletion. Although the central sectors of society could not understand the details of the chemists' warnings, they nevertheless believed them and immediately took action. In contrast, with respect to global heating, many people — including those at the core of society — refuse to believe the warnings of climate scientists, even though both issues are global in scale and concern the survival of humankind. In both cases, the scientists centrally involved were awarded the Nobel Prize and are fully recognized within the scientific community. In both cases, the structure is the same: ozone depletion is caused by the release of chlorofluorocarbons, and global heating is caused by the release of CO₂. And in both cases, the release of these substances was driven by the desire for a more comfortable life. Why, then, was ozone-layer depletion readily believed, while global heating is not? As I wrote — not "Why do people not believe in global heating?" but "Why do people refuse to believe in global heating?" — the issue is not that they do not believe, but that they do not *want* to believe. And the reason they do not want to believe is easy to imagine. To halt global heating, humankind must acknowledge that the way of life of the past three hundred years since the Industrial Revolution — a way of life in which many have taken pride — was mistaken, and must be changed. Their self-esteem does not allow them to admit this.

The fact that "the humanosphere revolves around Religion" must have brought both benefits and harms. In particular, in the primitive ages when the essence of religion — speculation and prayer concerning causality and the acceptance of their outcomes — was the sole guide for life, its benefits must have been at their greatest. In those ages, humankind survived precisely through religion. Even today, many people cling to religions born in antiquity because the memory of those benefits has been transmitted across generations. However, as civilization in the above sense developed — that is, as the knowledge that constitutes civilization became more accurate, more advanced, and more abundant — it naturally became clear that many religious speculations were mistaken. The present age is such an age. And in such an age, to cling to religions born in antiquity is, inevitably, a great harm. When religious knowledge stands in opposition to the supreme good — namely, the survival of humankind — the harm becomes extreme. And today, such harm appears to be prevailing throughout the world. An extreme example of this will be presented below.

On April 9, 2026, I watched a terrifying documentary: the second part of NHK's program "Evangelicals Who Long for Armageddon and Influence U.S. Politics," produced in 2023 by four European countries, including Norway and Finland. According to dictionaries, "Armageddon" is a term from the Book of Revelation at the end of the New Testament, originally referring to the final battlefield between the forces of good and evil, and by extension, the final conflict or the end of the world.

The words I associate with "Christianity" are "charity," "compassion," "peace," and the like. The Christians around me are all gentle and benevolent people. They regard the Book of Revelation as something inscrutable and simply ignore it. They also avoid the passage in Genesis — "And God said, Let us make man in our image, after our likeness" — considering it an embarrassing expression. They do not embrace the Bible in its entirety, but only those

parts they judge worthy of being embraced. This is a genuinely reasonable attitude, for everything in the world possesses both strengths and weaknesses. Evangelicalism, as portrayed in the documentary, is far removed from these. What they long for is the final battle to occur as soon as possible, so that the world may end. For they believe that at that moment Christ will return, and that they, as the faithful, will be forgiven at the Last Judgment and granted eternal life in the Kingdom of God.

Evangelicals do not merely wait for the final battle; they seek to bring it about. For them, the forces of good are Christians, and the forces of evil are all non-Christians, especially Muslims. Judaism in Israel — which is in conflict with Islamic nations over Palestine — is, in their view, the prototype of Christianity. Thus they expect Palestine to be the starting point of the final battle. They desire the Palestinian conflict to intensify, and they encourage such intensification, believing that the more severe the conflict becomes, the closer the final battle and the end of the world will be. Even the end of the world through global heating is, for them, something to be welcomed.

If Evangelicals were a small minority, this would not be a major problem. But according to the documentary, one in four Americans belongs to Evangelicalism, and political leaders supported by Evangelical leaders have become presidents. These leaders, in turn, have influenced presidential decisions, including interventions in the Palestinian conflict and the halting of global-heating countermeasures. Moreover, Evangelicalism is expanding. Military chaplains are sent to indoctrinate exhausted new recruits during harsh training, converting them when their judgment is weakened.

If the United States were neither a military power nor an economic power — nor a nation driven by the ideology of wealth acquisition — this would not be a global concern. But the United States is all of these. It can start wars through its military power, accelerate global heating through its wealth-acquisitive ideology, and obstruct global-heating countermeasures. And it has done so. In February 2026, the United States began military action against Iran, and earlier it withdrew from the Paris Agreement on climate change.

The above is not merely a summary of the documentary; it is a summary supplemented by my own annotations concerning related events. What follows is my own reflection, assuming that the documentary accurately represents the situation in the United States.

The first thought that came to me was that the Christian Reformation may, in the end, have been a failure. The Catholic Church, the old church, possesses the Vatican as its center, and its head, the Pope, is elected by clergy from around the world and is generally regarded as a person of considerable stature. In particular, the previous Pope, Francis, not only preached peace but also emphasized, in his publications, the gravity of global heating and other forms of damage to the biosphere. In contrast, Protestantism, the new church, lacks a central authority. Its denominations and congregations are fragmented, and their leaders are inevitably a mixture of the admirable and the harmful. One of the harmful ones, I suspect, is the leadership of the Evangelical movement. Perhaps even Luther could not foresee that this would happen.

The next thought that occurred to me was that including the Book of Revelation in the Bible was an obvious mistake. Setting aside the uncertain origins of the text, and setting aside the

question of whether "revelation" — divine messages — can exist at all, which may stem from ancient error, ignorance, or deception, the book becomes increasingly bizarre as it proceeds. It can be interpreted in any number of ways, allowing anyone to brandish it as authority by saying, "The Bible says so."

Another thought that came to me was this: if, in the American Civil War, the North had not won and preserved the Union, but instead the South — including Texas, now a stronghold of Evangelicalism — had become the Confederate States of America, the world might have been somewhat better. The Confederacy might have become a nation that did not seek hegemony, like many Latin American countries, and the remaining United States, even if it had still become a powerful nation, might have been one not influenced by Evangelicalism. In any case, I do not wish to believe that the United States of today is a nation that fulfills Lincoln's ideals.

The last thought that came to me was this: the success of a nation does not lie in becoming a military power or an economic power. The true aim of a nation ought to be to guide its people toward human flourishing.

Turning my thoughts to Japan, I realize that since the Meiji era, Japan gravely misunderstood the proper aim of a nation. It distinguished itself through militarization and economic expansion, and until its defeat in 1945, it embodied — even more than the United States today — the harm inherent in the fact that "the humanosphere revolves around Religion." Until that time, State Shinto, which regarded the Emperor as the incarnation of God, functioned as the de facto state religion. The Emperor possessed sovereign political authority, and nationalism arose that regarded this national structure as inherently superior. Japan pursued militarization and waged wars or invasions against all its neighboring countries — China, Korea, Russia, and the United States. After its defeat in 1945, this trajectory collapsed. The new constitution renounced the use of force, the Emperor became a human rather than a deity, and sovereignty came to reside in the people. Yet Japan then became an economic great power, and in the process released vast amounts of CO₂, contributing to the acceleration of global heating — a situation that continues today. However, as stated in §4.1, traditional religions no longer hold power in contemporary Japan. This does not mean that modern Japanese people lack faith. Rather, I believe that their objects of faith are science and philosophy. That is, many people accept and trust the judgments of scientists and philosophers, even without understanding their details. For example, while there appears to be conflict between evolutionism and creationism in the United States, in Japan anyone who denies evolution would likely be regarded as eccentric.

We have now examined examples of the harm arising from the fact that "the humanosphere revolves around Religion." Yet what we must truly do is to discover and cultivate its benefits. And this lies precisely at the core of what Eusophy aims to achieve. As explained in the first half of §5.2, the essence of religion — speculation and prayer concerning causality and the acceptance of their outcomes — plays an important role both in Eusophy and for each individual Eusophist. That is, under the supreme ethics that regards the survival of humankind as the supreme good, we must not reduce the achievements of science to mere objects of "belief or disbelief." Rather, we must accept them in their proper form as "the discovery, with evidence, of the laws that govern aspects of causality," and when science and

logic fall short, we must allow them to be supplemented by the above-mentioned essence of religion. This is the role entrusted to religion. Even for those who do not engage with Eusophy, if they wish to entrust themselves to religion, then — as explained in the latter half of §5.2 — they ought not cling to religions born in antiquity, thereby harming the dignity of humankind's essence as expressed in Observation (7): "Humankind is distinguished from other species by its intellect and its civilization." Instead, they should entrust themselves to a new form of religion aligned with that human essence and with the essence of a living being described in §3.2 as the bearer of the Baton of Life. Only such a religion is worthy of being the center around which the entire humanosphere moves.

Conclusion

"The foolishness of flies" is a phrase that often comes to my mind. A fly buzzes around the windowpane in front of my desk. Its noise distracts me, yet I dislike killing it, so I open the window to let it out. But the fly seems unaware that the window has been opened. I try to guide it toward the opening, yet it flees in the opposite direction, as if to nullify my kindness, and refuses to leave. Whenever I witness human behavior resembling this habit of flies, the phrase "the foolishness of flies" returns to me. One example is the anti-scientific behavior of those who deny the climatologists' finding that global heating is caused by the massive release of CO₂ from the large-scale combustion of fossil fuels since the Industrial Revolution. The species of flies must have existed for a long time. If they cannot immediately notice an open window, they should at least possess the habit of following guidance toward it, for that would be more conducive to survival. Yet they have not adapted to the new environment created by humankind — namely, window glass and human guidance. Similarly, insects that "fly into the flame" or circle around electric lights are not attracted to light itself. Entomologists tell us that they evolved to fly with their backs to the sun or the moon, and they mistake artificial lights for celestial ones, thereby flying in the wrong direction. They too have not adapted to the new environment created by humankind. Will the species of flies eventually perish because of such maladaptation? Or will they adapt and survive?

"Those who cannot discern differences" and "those who refuse to change" are also phrases that often come to my mind. A simple example: after Tokyo Disneyland was built, theme parks resembling it were constructed across Japan, yet most failed to achieve comparable success. Their creators likely could not discern the differences between those parks and Disneyland. Likewise, although the internet has realized the ideal of universal participation in the sharing of social information, some people cling to the old form of print publication. They either cannot discern the difference between the old form and the realized ideal, or they discern it but refuse to change. Yet in matters far more serious than these, most people are either "unable to discern differences" or "unwilling to change." The world has largely been governed by the ideology of wealth acquisition, and this has caused global heating — a near-future threat to the survival of humankind. Yet people either cannot discern the difference between economy and wealth-acquisitive ideology, or they discern it but refuse to change their way of life to escape its dominance.

"Fallen idol" originally means a toppled idol, but it is often used metaphorically to refer to someone who has fallen from the seat of admiration. In the British film "The Fallen Idol", a boy's admired man becomes suspected of murdering his wife after an affair; the boy is

disillusioned. Lenin, the architect of the Soviet state, and General Lee, commander of the Confederate Army in the American Civil War, also became fallen idols. Not only metaphorically: statues of Lenin were toppled, broken, and scorned in Ukraine after its independence; Lee's statue was removed in 2020 during protests following the death of a Black citizen under police restraint — a tragedy rooted in the long history of persecution and discrimination against Black people, and ultimately in the South's insistence on preserving slavery, the major cause of the Civil War. In this treatise, I have traced the path of my own mind — from the logical understanding of intellect and the universe in MN, through my encounter with the opening verse of the "Gospel of John," to the logical understanding of God in FM, and finally to the proposal of Eusophy, a new intellectual endeavor vital both for humankind and for each individual. Along this path, many idols have fallen. Scholars, thinkers, and religious figures of past and present alike have lost their authority in my mind, for although their existence should be justified by answering the urgent questions concerning humankind and the individual, they either did not face such questions or failed to find satisfactory answers. And the greatest fallen idol is the way of life humankind has followed since the Industrial Revolution, for it is this way of life that has caused global heating and thereby brought about the threat to the survival of humankind.

Earlier, in explaining the norm for Eusophists, I wrote: "Should someone arise who devotes themselves to the establishment of Eusophy — especially someone who assumes a leading role — such a person is the one I would respect, and such a person's judgments are the ones I would trust. And for anyone, such a person is worthy of respect, and such judgments are worthy of trust." When I reread this passage, the word "Messiah" came to mind. The term originally refers to the anticipated savior of the Jews, and in the New Testament — the scripture that separates Christianity from Judaism — it refers to Jesus Christ, when regarded as the savior. Two thousand years ago, a figure like Jesus may indeed have deserved the title of savior. But today, things are different. In the present age, the person who assumes a leading role in establishing Eusophy deserves that title. The threat of global heating to the near-future survival of humankind is grave enough to require a new savior. The New Testament contains the story of the Magi — the Three Kings — who sought out the newborn Jesus. They are often called "wise men," and perhaps the "wise" in the Anglo-Saxon "Witenagemot" ("assembly of the wise") and in "Homo sapiens" ("wise man") originally meant "those who can discern what is worthy of trust."

But in any case, whatever may have been true two thousand years ago, the object of trust that must be sought today is not a figure like Jesus. We must seek the person who can play a leading role in establishing Eusophy — the person whose teaching we ought to trust, disseminate, and practice for the sake of humankind's survival. To do so — and to attain pride in one's own spirit, and to engage rightly in any intellectual endeavor — we must overcome the foolishness of flies, the inability to discern differences, and the obstinacy that refuses to change. We must also abandon reliance on past authorities and instead possess the resolve to "establish a new authority so great that past authorities become fallen idols." For it is precisely because humankind hesitated, misunderstood, or rejected the necessary transformations — out of such foolishness, lack of discernment, and obstinacy — and because it relied on past authorities without such resolve, that we have lost decades while global heating advanced. Although this treatise began as an attempt to express my own thoughts, it has inevitably resulted in various criticisms, explicit or implicit, of past authorities. I

ask that you receive this with generosity of heart. And I ask that you contribute not to the survival of any particular authority, but to the survival of humankind. For that is the survival that truly possesses value.